

DON'T STASH THAT CASH!

Most financial planning fails because we don't have an efficient cash flow system in place. The chapter tells you how to build your own system of managing inflows and outflows each month.

Anupama Gajwani is not the usual Indian woman you run into. Growing up with an artist dad in a house filled with paintings and the smell of turpentine, my childhood friend Anu and I are as different as it comes.

My steady boring planned ant-like world contrasts with her 'let's-eat-that-goddam-lemon-tart-now!' life. Freelance designer Anu is a single mom and lives from assignment to assignment, thinks nothing of taking off to Toronto to see her son cleaning out her bank account.

I've never bothered to talk money with her because planning is not what she does and sounds boring when you have so many cool stories to hear! It must be age, or stage, or a bolt from the sky above that got her; but early January last year when we met for one of our Sunday lunch sessions, her new passion was getting her money life in order.

'Hey! Hey! Hey! You have to help me. I will do this. Now. Now. Now!' Not your usual mid-forties person for sure. 'I have no idea where my money goes. I know when it comes into the bank, but after that it is a blur,' she says.

Not knowing where our money goes is not a problem peculiar to a certain personality. Think back: Don't you remember saying, 'I have no idea where my